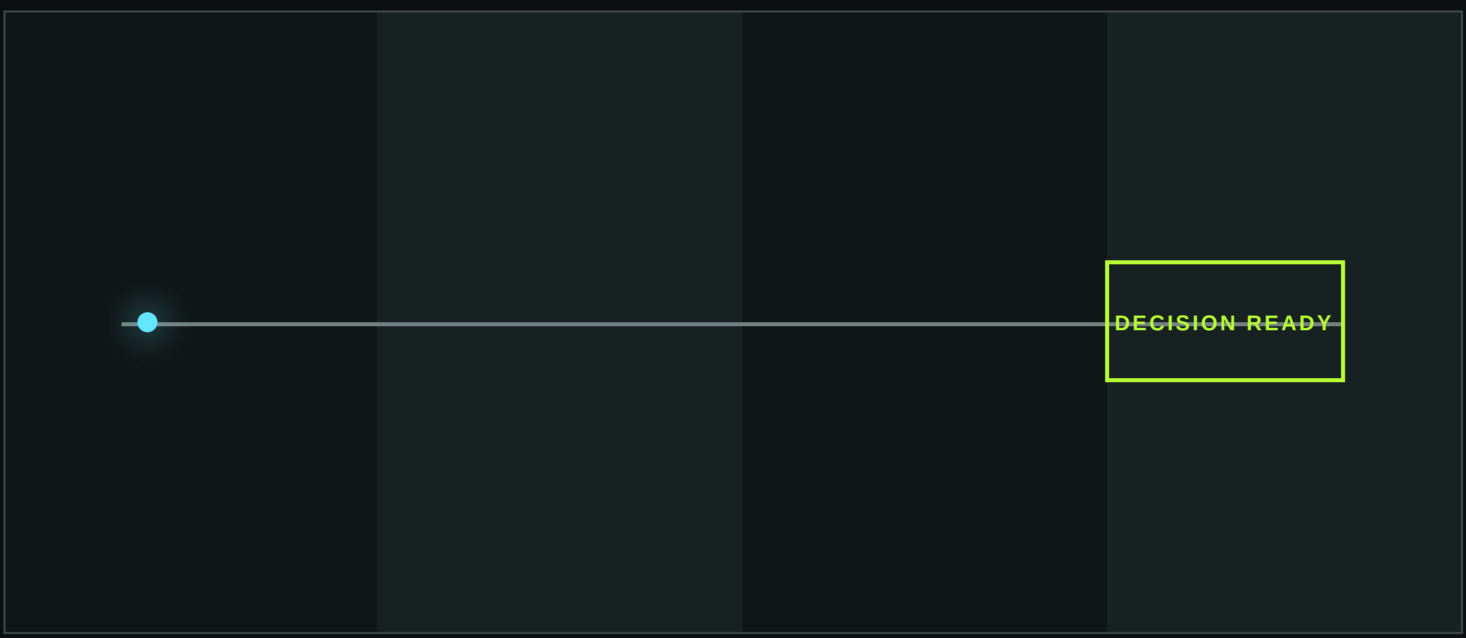
INDEPENDENT CANDIDATE THESIS BRIEF

# Decision Advantage before the mission window opens.

Product Associate Director (Group Product Manager)

Candidate thesis by Russell Dudek




Mission Window Contract: mission outcome + human authority + integration fit + evidence threshold + acquisition path + field-learning return.

# Russell Dudek

**Interview Thesis Brief - Product Associate Director (Group Product Manager)**

INDEPENDENT CANDIDATE MATERIALS

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## 1. The actual work behind the title

**Turn Two Six's expanding Decision Advantage portfolio into a coherent product operating system that arrives ahead of emerging mission opportunities without weakening operator trust, legacy-system compatibility, or team autonomy.**

### Company moment

- Proprietary product growth and recurring-revenue expansion.
- Helix positions agentic orchestration as a bridge from legacy to AI.
- Sentr turns the orchestration layer into a mission-specific information-operations product.
- SIGMA demonstrates live, cross-agency CBRNE sensor integration.
- Leadership expansion signals deliberate product, engineering, sales, and strategy scaling.

### Operating consequence

If product decisions remain local and support learning remains trapped in programs, the portfolio risks duplicated integration work, inconsistent evidence standards, late acquisition positioning, and weaker platform leverage.

*This is a source-grounded hypothesis for discovery, not a statement about current internal performance.*

### Four tensions to manage

| TENSION | WHAT MUST BE TRUE | PRODUCT-LEADERSHIP RESPONSE |
|---|---|---|
| Frontier AI vs. mission assurance | Speed without opaque or unbounded action | Explicit authority, traceability, evaluation, fallback, and release evidence |
| Portfolio leverage vs. mission specificity | Reuse without flattening operator work | Shared decision contract; product-specific workflows and outcomes |
| Empowered teams vs. top-down direction | Local judgment with coherent investment | Clear portfolio decisions, constraints, and feedback cadence |
| Product economics vs. support reality | Mission support becomes learning, not hidden labor | Instrument recurring support, deployment, and integration patterns |

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## 2. The Mission Window Contract

A shared decision record for portfolio bets. It aligns the questions product, engineering, UX, growth, sales, program, support, and mission leaders must answer before capacity is committed.

| CONTRACT FIELD | DECISION QUESTION | EVIDENCE EXAMPLES |
|---|---|---|
| Mission outcome | Which enduring operator problem changes, for whom, and under what consequence? | Decision latency, action quality, mission completion, risk avoided |
| Human authority | What may AI recommend or execute, and what remains a named human decision? | Approval checkpoints, doctrine, fallback, auditability |
| Integration fit | What environment, data, legacy systems, security, and access constraints shape the product? | Deployment path, interoperability, data locality, uptime |
| Evidence threshold | What proof justifies accelerate, scale, integrate, hold, or stop? | Evaluation coverage, adoption, reliability, support intensity |
| Acquisition path | How does the customer buy, fund, deploy, and sustain the capability? | Vehicle fit, budget owner, deployment effort, service burden |
| Learning return | What field signal must change the roadmap or platform investment? | Support recurrence, user behavior, mission results, rework |

### Portfolio decision rights

#### Portfolio leadership decides

- Investment thesis
- Cross-product platform bets
- Capacity conflicts
- Evidence thresholds
- Scale or stop posture

#### Product teams decide

- User/problem discovery
- Solution sequencing
- Backlog detail
- Experiment design
- Day-to-day tradeoffs

#### Joint decisions

- Release posture
- Human authority
- Mission assurance
- GTM positioning
- Support productization

### Scorecard

Mission outcome, product behavior, trust/risk, adoption/support, economics/acquisition, and learning speed. Baselines and targets should be established with the teams rather than invented in advance.

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## 3. Proof, entry, and executive discussion

### Verified proof map

**Compunetics:** advanced electronics, DoD collaboration, R&D/program leadership, engineering, manufacturing, quality, high-reliability delivery.

**Vape-Jet:** AI-first transformation, support-heavy B2B product environment, roughly 1,000 fielded robots, factory/field/customer/machine signals turned into prioritized work.

**DudeWorth:** agentic workflow design with retrieval, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, and governance.

**Amazon and ZeusVu:** customer-backward launches, operating cadence, regulated autonomous systems, field risk, and governed execution.

### First 120 days

**1-30:** read portfolio, missions, users, roadmaps, support, acquisition, constraints, and team craft.

**31-60:** establish contract, decision rights, scorecard definitions, three portfolio hypotheses, and AI-assisted tradecraft pilots.

**61-90:** run Mission Window Reviews with live product decisions; coach PM/UX in the work.

**91-120:** institutionalize quarterly portfolio review, field-learning return, executive roadmap narrative, and next-bet decisions.

### Contribution case

Russell's operating advantage is the ability to connect technical work, product support, quality, field constraints, AI-enabled workflows, and executive decisions while remaining hands-on.

### Executive questions

1. Where does Decision Advantage lose the most time today?
2. Which portfolio decisions are unclear or too slow?
3. What platform leverage should Helix create without erasing product differentiation?
4. What evidence earns investment and what evidence triggers a stop?
5. Which support patterns should become product capability?
6. What should be materially stronger after 120 days?